

Website Design Guide



Visual standards, component patterns, and rules of the road for the Monroe Elementary website.

Version 1.0 · May 2026 · Pages covered: 13

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How Monroe writes for the web

Color Palette

All colors are defined as CSS custom properties in `assets/styles.css`. Never hardcode hex values — always reference the token. Tints may use `rgba`.

					
CREAM --cream #fdf8f2	CREAM 2 --cream2 #f5ede0	PAPER --paper #fdf9ec	INK --ink #1a1410	MONARCH --monarch #e26a1f	CYAN --cyan #2bb8d4
					
MARIGOLD --marigold #f0a82e	MAGENTA --magenta #d83a6d	POPPY --poppy #d8392e	JADE --jade #4d8c5c	PLUM --plum #7c3f88	HERO BG (page hdrs) #fef5ec

COLOR ROLES

- Monarch:**
Primary CTA buttons, section H2 emspans, kicker
- Marigold:**
Cantonese Biliteracy pathway, secondary accent,
- Jade:**
Events category, garden/environmental content, nth-
- Poppy:**
Urgent/emergency notices, first segment of rainbow
- Cyan:**
Spanish Immersion pathway color, active nav
- Magenta:**
ELD pathway, tertiary accent, event category tags,
- Plum:**
Resources category, PTA section, alternating accent
- Ink:**
All body text, borders (always 1.5px solid)

NEVER USE

Hardcoded hex values in page CSS. Always var(--token). Tints: `rgba(26,20,16,.15)` or `rgba(43,184,212,.2)` etc. Pathway colors: cyan = Spanish Immersion · marigold = Chinese Biliteracy · magenta = ELD.

Typography

Outfit is the sole typeface for all English text. Chinese uses ZCOOL XiaoWei or Noto Serif TC. Never introduce a serif or decorative font.

Page H1

Outfit 900
clamp(44–88px)
tracking: -0.02em

The people who make Monroe

Section H2

Outfit 700
clamp(32–44px)
tracking: -0.02em

Programs that **celebrate** every language.

Kicker

Outfit 800
11px
0.22em ALL CAPS · token color

OUR SCHOOL & PROGRAMS

FAMILY LIAISONS

COMMUNITY HUB

Body

Outfit 400
15–16px
line-height 1.6 rgba(ink,.75)

Twenty-three classroom teachers, three bilingual pathways, 360 students.

Small/Meta

Outfit 400–700
11–13px
rgba(ink,.5)

Apr 18 · Sent via ParentSquare · 6 min read

Chinese

ZCOOL XiaoWei
or Noto Serif TC

Xue Wen You Ai Xin Wang Zhi Xing

NEVER USE

Playfair Display, Georgia, or any serif font. Outfit is the only typeface for all English headings, body copy, labels, and UI. Chinese-language text uses ZCOOL XiaoWei or Noto Serif TC.

Page Structure

Every page follows the same vertical stacking order. Sections alternate background colors for visual rhythm.

Utility bar address · hours · language · ParentSquare →
Masthead & Nav logo · nav · Tour the School · Give →
Page Header bg: #fef5ec · H1 text · 900 · kicker above
Content section (light) bg: --cream · padding 80px 40px
Content section (mid) bg: --cream2 · alternates with cream
Accent section (dark) bg: --ink · text: --cream · one per page
Content section bg: --cream
Footer logo · nav · cols · address · copyright

RAINBOW STRIPE

Required on every page after the page header. 14 spans (7 colors × 2). Height: 6px. Order: poppy → monarch → marigold → jade → cyan → plum → magenta, repeat once.

SECTION BACKGROUND RHYTHM

Sections alternate --cream / --cream2. Use --ink for a single dark accent section per page. Never use arbitrary hex backgrounds.

PAGE HEADER

Background: #fef5ec (--paper variant). H1 at Outfit 900. Kicker label above H1 in token color. Always paired with rainbow stripe below.

GRAIN TEXTURE

Every page loads assets/grain.js deferred. Grain overlay: z-index 9998, mix-blend-mode: multiply, opacity 1.

MAX WIDTH & PADDING

Section inner: max-width 1240px, centered. Padding: 80px 40px desktop · 40px 20px mobile.

BORDER RULE

All structural borders: 1.5px solid var(--ink). Never use box-shadow blur or border-radius on layout elements. Cards use 5px 5px 0 flat offset shadow.

Components

Core UI blocks. All cards share ink 1.5px border + flat 5px offset shadow. No border-radius, no box-shadow blur.

CARDS



Always: 1.5px --ink border · 5px 5px 0 offset shadow · border-radius 0
 Shadow colors: rotate through token palette (nth-child or explicit).
 Never: border-radius · drop-shadow filter · hover lift effect.

BUTTONS



1.5px ink border · 3px 3px 0 ink offset shadow · Square · ink bg · 4px 4px 0 ink offset shadow · Square · ink bg · 3px 3px ink shadow

SECTION HEADING

OUR SCHOOL

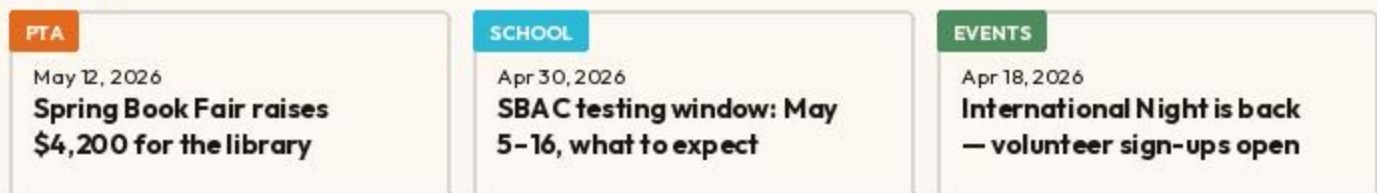
Programs that **celebrate** every language.

Three bilingual pathways woven through every grade, K-5

Kicker: Outfit 800 · 10-11px · 0.22em tracking · ALL CAPS · token color

H2: Outfit 700 · clamp(32-44px) · -0.02em tracking · em spans · color: var(--monarch)

NEWS CARD

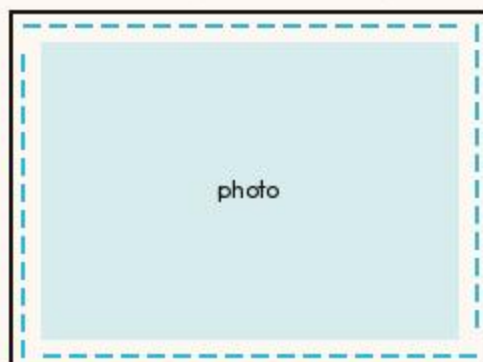


News cards use subtle rounded border (4px) — distinct from content cards. Category tag top-left.

Image Elements

Photo treatments use layered borders, not box-shadow blur. Every image frame reinforces the site's flat, structured aesthetic.

FRAMED PHOTO (.FRAMED-PHOTO)



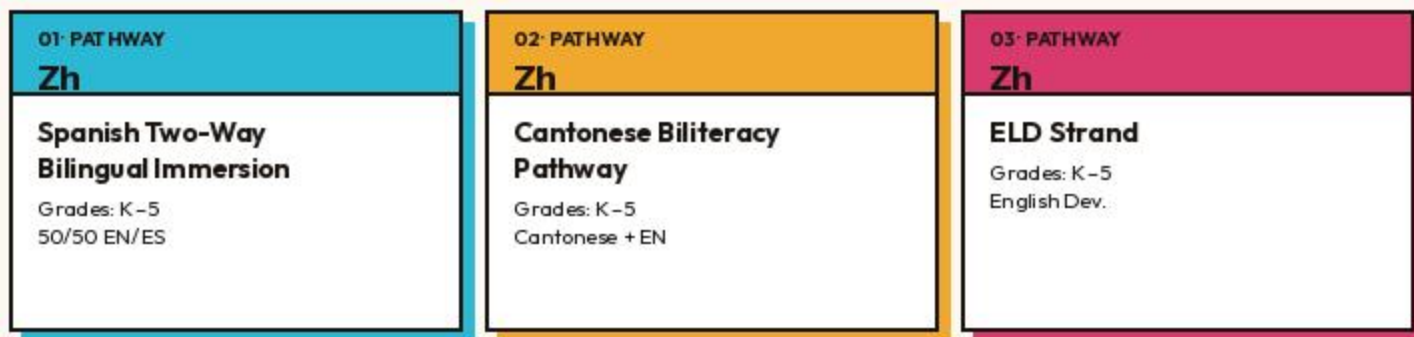
1.5px solid var(--ink) outer border

1.5px dashed var(--color) inner border
(offset: 5px from outer edge)

Image fill: object-fit: cover
(offset: 14px from outer edge)

Dashed border color = token color (rotates: --cyan, --marigold, --magenta, --jade...)

PROGRAM CARD (.PROGRAM-CARD)



Banner: colored bg + 1.5px ink border-bottom. Body: white bg, Outfit. Shadow: 6px 6px 0 (cycles cyan→marigold→magenta).

STAFF PHOTO (.SUPPORT-BLOCK_PHOTO)



Circular crop: border-radius 50% · 1.5px solid var(--ink) · object-position: center 25% · used in staff/liaisons sections.

HERO IMAGE OVERLAY



Navigation

Navigation components match across all pages. Masthead sticks on scroll. Dropdown appears on hover/focus with keyboard support.

UTILITY BAR



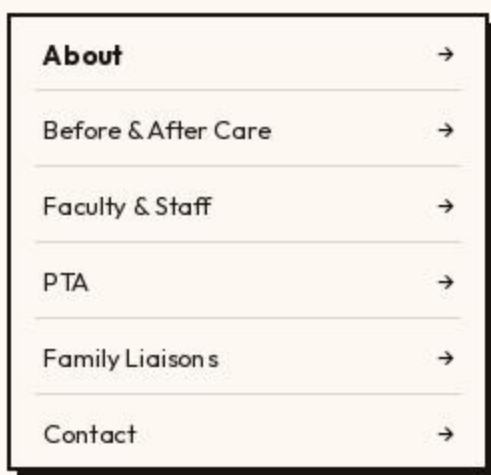
bg: --cream · border-bottom: 1.5px solid --ink · Outfit 12px

MASTHEAD



bg: --cream · border-bottom: 1.5px solid --ink · active item: 3px --cyan underline

DROPDOWN



bg: --cream · border: 1.5px solid --ink · box-shadow: 5px 5px 0px --ink
items: 12px Outfit 700 UPPERCASE · dashed dividers · arrow right

Top-level items: Outfit 700 · 13px · 0.04em tracking · UPPERCASE **Active state:** 3px solid --cyan border-bottom on nav item

Dropdown trigger: ◻ caret at 9px opacity .6

Mobile nav: Full-screen overlay · bg: --cream · items 14px 700

Hamburger: 40×40px · 1.5px ink border · 3 bars 2px ink

Voice & Tone

Monroe's voice is warm, practical, and celebratory. We write as neighbors — never as a bureaucracy.

Warm, not distant

We, you, our families. Never: the school community, stakeholders, or end users.

Clear, not jargon-heavy

6th-grade reading level. Spell out acronyms. Say reading support, not literacy intervention.

Inclusive, always

Every message should feel meant for all families — offer Spanish and Chinese translations for key announcements.

Celebratory, not boastful

Highlight students and families, not the institution. Monroe belongs to everyone.

Action-oriented

Every page has one clear next step. Join, Give, Sign up, Learn more — never just information dumps.

WEB COPY EXAMPLES

✓ DO

- ✓ Join us Thursday — your voice shapes how Monroe works.
- ✓ Our 3rd graders are reading more than ever — and loving it.
- ✓ Update your emergency contacts in ParentSquare — takes 2 minutes.

✗ DON'T

- ✗ Stakeholders are encouraged to participate in the upcoming event.
- ✗ Students demonstrated measurable growth in literacy benchmarks.
- ✗ Submit your emergency contact information via the ParentSquare portal.

Questions?

contact@monroepta.org · monroepta.org

Styles: [assets/styles.css](#) · Tokens: [monroe-tokens.json](#)

Monroe Elementary Website Style Guide · V1.0 · May 2026